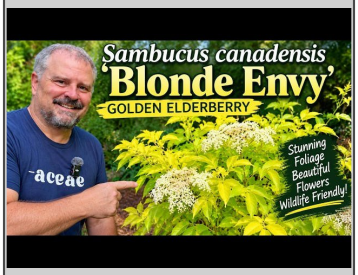
Atlanta Botanical Garden - Expansion

Sambucus canadensis 'Blonde Envy'

Blonde Envy Elderberry

Family: Viburnaceae (or Adoxaceae)

Beltline N_S: 10 **TOTAL 10**



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



OTHER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 5–6 ft (1.5–1.8 m) high × 6–8 ft (1.8–2.4 m) wide.
Multi-stemmed Moderate to Suckering tendency

Sun

Water

Soil
Average to moist, well-drained soils

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 5–9. Excellent for Atlanta Zone 8a. Discovered in Fairfield County / near Columbia, SC — thrives in full sun, heat, and humidity. Bright yellow foliage that holds color. White flower clusters followed by purple edible fruit. Heat-tolerant gold-leaf selection

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Cultivar of native American elderberry (Sambucus canadensis). Wild discovery by plantsman Keith Mearns in Fairfield County, South Carolina (railroad right-of-way near Columbia). Selected for superior heat tolerance and non-fading yellow foliage compared to northern gold-leaf selections

Form
Deciduous multi-stemmed shrub. Brilliant yellow foliage throughout the growing season (does not fade). Terminal clusters of tiny white flowers in late summer, followed by purple fruit. Loose, spreading habit. Attracts birds and pollinators. Edible fruit and flowers. Southern-discovered gold-leaf elderberry with superior heat and humidity tolerance. Bright yellow foliage holds all season. White flowers and edible purple fruit. Native parent. Excellent for Atlanta

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun for best yellow color (chartreuse in shade). Tolerates moist soils. Prune hard if needed to control size. Cross-pollination improves fruit set. Excellent for naturalized areas, borders, and wildlife. Water to establish

HEALTH

Health

Generally low maintenance. Heat and humidity tolerant. Attracts pollinators and birds. Fruit edible when cooked.
No serious problems stated as dominant. May sucker

Symptoms

None stated